

LET ME TRY · FREE PRINTABLE

Pouring Work: A 4-Step Montessori Sequence

Practical life · Ages 2–3 · 10 minutes a day

Pouring builds hand-eye coordination, concentration and independence. Move to the next step only when your child is pouring the current one calmly and with few spills.

You'll need

- ○ A small tray
- ○ Two small jugs with handles (steel or small glass)
- ○ Dry rajma, chana or whole moong
- ○ A small sponge and a cloth
- ○ Their own small tumbler for meals

Step 1: Dry pouring

- ○ Fill one jug a third full with beans.
- ○ Pour into the empty jug, then back again.
- ○ Pick up dropped beans with fingers. That's fine-motor practice too.

Step 2: Show, don't tell

- ○ Sit to your child's right, so they can see your hands clearly.
- ○ Hold the handle, support the spout with two fingers, tip slowly.
- ○ Say almost nothing. Let them watch.
- ○ Offer: 'Would you like a turn?'

Step 3: Water

- ○ Start with a third of a jug. Add a drop of food colour to make it easy to see.
- ○ Keep a sponge on the tray. Show how to squeeze it out.

Step 4: Real life

- ○ Their own water at every meal.
- ○ Pouring dal water for the plants.
- ○ Pouring milk onto cereal or poha.

Troubleshooting

- ○ Lots of spills? Use less in the jug and a smaller jug.
- ○ Throwing beans? Calmly put the tray away: 'We'll try again later.'
- ○ Bored? Add a funnel or a third container.

SOURCES AND FURTHER READING

Montessori, M. The Discovery of the Child (practical life exercises).
Lillard, A. S. (2017). Montessori: The Science Behind the Genius. Oxford University Press.

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